

KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558-69

Assessment Question: From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558				
L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559				
L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement				
L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the rigid structure of Elizabethan society, the concept of the Great Chain of Being, and the mechanics of Tudor government, including the roles of the Court, Privy Council, and Parliament.
- ☐ Analyse the intense challenges Elizabeth faced regarding her legitimacy, sixteenth-century gender prejudices against a 'Queen Regnant', and the political dilemma of marriage.
- ☐ Evaluate the interconnected domestic and foreign threats facing England in 1558, specifically severe financial weaknesses, the loss of Calais, and the dangerous 'Auld Alliance' between France and Scotland.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What vital English territory was lost to France in 1559 under the Treaty of Cateau-Cambr sis?

2. Define: Queen Regnant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Auld Alliance' viewed as a direct geographical threat to Elizabethan England?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about why Catholics viewed Elizabeth as an illegitimate monarch.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Great Chain of Being | Patronage | Privy Council | Queen Regnant | Legitimacy | Debasement | Auld Alliance

When Elizabeth ascended the throne in 1558, Tudor society was strictly organized according to the _____, a hierarchical structure where everyone had a fixed place. To maintain control and reward loyalty, the Queen relied heavily on the system of _____, distributing land and titles to powerful nobles. She was advised by a small, elite group of trusted ministers called the _____. However, as an unmarried _____, she faced immense challenges, including Catholic doubts about her _____, economic ruin caused by the _____ of the coinage, and the constant foreign threat of the _____ between France and Scotland.

Exam Practice

1. "Economic difficulties were the most significant challenge Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

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2. "Elizabeth's government was completely dependent on the Privy Council." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

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3. Describe one feature of the role of the Justices of the Peace (JPs). (2 marks) Describe one feature of the role of the Justices of the Peace (JPs). (2 marks)

4. Describe one feature of Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government. (2 marks)
Describe one feature of Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government. (2 marks)

5. Explain why Elizabeth faced challenges at home and from abroad upon her accession in 1558. (12 marks)

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the key features and impact of Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559), including the Act of Supremacy and the Act of Uniformity.
- ☐ Analyse the crucial role of the Church of England in society, specifically its function in enforcing social control, managing Church courts, and conducting visitations.
- ☐ Evaluate the nature and extent of the Puritan and Catholic challenges to the religious settlement, including the role of the nobility, the Papacy, and foreign powers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What vital English territory was lost to France in 1559 under the Treaty of Cateau-Cambr sis?

2. Define: Queen Regnant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Auld Alliance' viewed as a direct geographical threat to Elizabethan England?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the financial weaknesses Elizabeth inherited in 1558.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Puritan Recusant Royal Injunctions Visitations
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Your Sentence:

Exam Practice

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2. Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in early Elizabethan society. (2 marks)
Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in early Elizabethan society. (2 marks)

3. Explain why Elizabeth's religious settlement was introduced in 1559. (12 marks)

General Notes

[illegible]

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the nature and extent of the Puritan challenge, focusing on their theological objections, the Crucifix Controversy, and the Vestment Controversy.
- ☐ Evaluate the Catholic challenge at home, including recusancy and the rising threat of the northern nobility.
- ☐ Analyse the existential threat from abroad, encompassing the Counter-Reformation, the 1570 Papal Bull of excommunication, and the looming shadow of foreign superpowers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What year was the Religious Settlement passed?

2. Define: Recusant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Act of Supremacy' carefully worded to make Elizabeth the 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about why the Church of England was essential for social control.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Counter-Reformation**

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. 'The nature and extent of the Catholic challenge was a greater threat to Elizabeth's religious settlement than the Puritan challenge in the years 1559–69.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

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2. Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement in the years 1559–69. (12 marks)

3. Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the religious settlement. (2 marks) Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the religious settlement. (2 marks)

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the strength of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne and why English Catholics viewed her as the legitimate monarch.
- ☐ Explain the dramatic events in Scotland that forced Mary to abdicate and flee across the border into England in 1568.
- ☐ Analyse the profound dilemma Mary's arrival created for Elizabeth, including the investigation into the 'Casket Letters' and the strategic decision to keep her in captivity.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What was the main flashpoint of the Vestment Controversy in 1566?

2. Define: The Counter-Reformation

3. Explain: What did the 1570 Papal Bull explicitly instruct English Catholics to do?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Abdicate | Casket Letters | Divine Right of Kings | Conference of York

Following a scandalous marriage to the man suspected of murdering her husband, Scottish nobles rebelled against Mary, forcing her to _____ her throne in favor of her infant son. When Mary fled to England seeking Elizabeth's help, she carried the unshakeable belief that she was chosen by God under the _____. However, Elizabeth refused to restore her to power, instead organizing the _____ to investigate Mary's alleged crimes. The primary evidence presented against Mary were the highly controversial _____, a collection of poems and documents that supposedly proved her involvement in the murder.

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Practice

1. Describe one feature of the threat posed by Mary, Queen of Scots when she arrived in England in 1568. (2 marks) Describe one feature of the threat posed by Mary, Queen of Scots when she arrived in England in 1568. (2 marks)

2. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in 1568 caused problems for Elizabeth. (12 marks)

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
